

assert himself as an orchestral composer met with frustration. The true story of his “Unfinished” Symphony, written in 1822, has never been established—it is uncertain whether he only completed the first two movements and the opening bars of the third movement or whether the rest of the symphony has simply been lost. Either way, this innovative work was never performed in Schubert’s lifetime. His “Great” Symphony in C major, now considered one of the supreme pieces in the concert repertoire, was accepted for rehearsal by the orchestra of Vienna’s Society of Friends of Music in 1827, but then declared too difficult to perform.

**“Whenever I attempted to *sing* of *love*, it
turned to *pain*.”**

FRANZ SCHUBERT, MY DREAM, 1822

Despite such setbacks, Schubert’s creative drive was at full strength in his final years. Works such as his last three piano sonatas, written in 1828, were complex achievements, harnessing a supreme lyrical gift for melody to an individual handling of large-scale musical structure. The late songs of the Winterreise cycle and the song collection Schwanengesang, both also from 1828, have a depth and range of feeling that announce the full onset of Romanticism. Schubert was only now beginning to receive the degree of recognition he craved. In March 1828, he gave a public concert of his works that was both a critical and a financial success. His renown at last began to spread beyond Vienna.